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Due Jun 29 11:59pm Available from Jun 23 until Jun 30 3 points possible

5 Replies, 5 Unread

Mise-en-Scène: Composition

Discussion

Citizen Kane **(Orson Welles, 1941)**

Initial post is DUE by [Sunday 6/29 at 11:59pm]. Reply post(s) due by [Sunday 6/29 at 11:59pm].

Purpose

Our discussion for this Module focuses on how the composition of films affects

how they communicate to us. We will focus on one of the greatest films of all time, Orson Welles's *Citizen Kane*, a film that has been studied for its mise-en-scène for decades. Design and composition are two elements of mise-en-scène that compliment each other. For this Module, we are primarily focusing on composition.

Instructions

For your **Initial Discussion Post** due by Sunday 6/29 at 11:59pm, please respond to the following prompt below in a post of at least 300 words. You do not have to address every detail of the prompt, but your post should contribute to the discussion and not merely repeat what has already been posted by your classmates. While I encourage you to offer your personal views of the films in this Module, **please refrain from unproductive summaries of story or plot and/or why a film is "good" or "bad."** Assume that everyone in the discussion group has completed the viewing assignment and understands the story/plot of the film. I suggest that you draft your post in Word first and assume that something may go wrong in Canvas when you hit 'Post Reply.' I will not count summary of plot/story or information that is not relevant to the prompt/analysis of one scene toward the required 300-word count. **Please identify the time 0(hr):00(min):00(sec) in the film** where the scene you are analyzing begins and concludes from the stream of the film included in the Module. Please do not repost the questions from this prompt into your post.

Your analysis should refer to course materials and reflect on how film style and history function. A post that earns full points will not merely agree with course materials, but will visually illustrate ideas through personal observation. **Do not forget to include embedded media that visualizes the example(s) in your post.** Please make sure that you read all of the posts in your discussion group before posting. I cannot give full points to posts that analyze scenes or shots that have already been selected by another classmate. Please limit your posts to no more than 400 words and 1-2 examples to give others a chance to write about key scenes/shots. **Please resize your screenshots and images to 'Extra Large' in the 'Image Options.'** The 'Image Options' tag appears above or below an image when you click on it while editing in the Rich Content Editor.

Grading Rubric Checklist for Full Points (Initial Post):

- Post identifies the time where the scene you are analyzing begins and concludes from the stream of the film included in the Module.
- **Post analyzes no less than one minute and no more than three minutes of one scene.** If you wish to discuss another scene, please do so in your response to another classmate.
- Post addresses materials related to the prompt and course materials.
- Post includes at least two embedded screen captures from the scene you are analyzing. **Please resize your screenshots and images to 'Extra Large' in the 'Image Options.'** The 'Image Options' tag appears above or below an image when you click on it while editing in the Rich Content Editor.
- Post does not analyze a scene previously selected by a classmate earlier in the thread. Sometimes a classmate will post about the scene you are analyzing while you are writing. It happens. Just message me and let me know.

Please Resize Your Screen Captures to 'Extra Large'

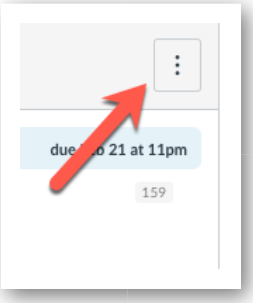
For your **Response Post** to one classmate due by Sunday 6/29 at 11:59pm, please reply in 75 words or more to at least one classmate's post. Responses may include describing your own insight related to the post, providing

additional information from assigned or outside content, disagreeing respectfully by describing your own interpretation, proposing a new idea, or asking a question. I cannot give full points to posts that merely "like" or agree with another post; the response post must demonstrate substantial effort. Please try to respond to a classmate who has not yet received a response.

- *Citizen Kane* showcases some impressive shots and sequences that illustrate Orson Welles's (and cinematographer Gregg Toland's) mastery of composition. As you learned in the reading, *where* people, objects, and buildings appear in the frame affects how we understand what a film communicates. It is important to keep in mind that mise-en-scène is just one aspect of film form. Composition and design are part of the overall picture along with cinematography (i.e. shot design, camera movement). Please choose one scene from *Citizen Kane* and **embed at least two (2) screenshots** from the scene into your post. How does the composition of your example affect how we experience its content? What Hollywood conventions does *Citizen Kane* subvert to shape its audience's experience? You also may wish to discuss how the film's narrative structure provides a unique cinematic experience while still adhering to the conventions of the invisible style. **Please refrain from choosing the scenes I have included in the Module: the deep space composition "Thompson nightclub/window" scene and the deep space composition "Boarding House/Thatcher" scene.**

Discussion Rubric

To view the grading rubric for this discussion, click on the "more options" icon (3 vertical dots at the top) and then select "show rubric".



Mobile App users: Click Grades, then click into the Discussion. The rubric can then be found on the Grades tab.

Aim for excellence! These are the criteria for what comprises an "Excellent" rating for a discussion post:

- Addresses each part of the discussion prompt(s).
- Postings demonstrate reflective and critical thinking, not just recitation of information from textbook.
- Makes connections to previous or current course content, or to real-life